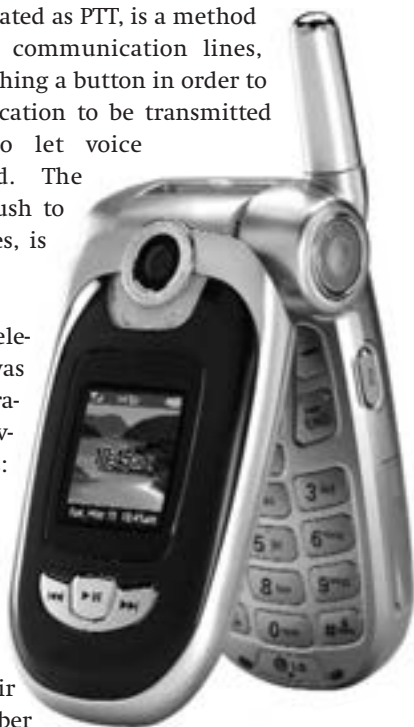


4.3 Push To Talk

Push to talk, commonly abbreviated as PTT, is a method of conversing on half-duplex communication lines, including two-way radio, by pushing a button in order to send, allowing voice communication to be transmitted from you, and releasing to let voice communication be received. The Symbian implementation of Push to Talk, as found on Nokia devices, is commonly referred to as DVS.

One of the earliest mobile telephone protocols used PTT. It was the mobile equivalent of operator-assisted land telephone service. The protocol was as follows: The mobile telephone user pressed and held their PTT (Push-To-Talk) button for several seconds to get the mobile operator's attention. When they released PTT, an operator would reply (transmit on their channel) and ask them the number then wanted. The user would key up (PTT) and tell the operator the number they wished. The operator would dial and connect the landline, and the conversation would proceed. When there was no activity for a while or the landline hung up, the operator could reuse the channel.



The term now more commonly refers to a feature available on certain more recent phone models. It allows the mobile phone, when in a special mode, to function as a digital two-way radio in push-to-talk operation (in a fashion similar to the “trunking” feature of newer commercial and public-safety two-way radios). Only one person at a time can talk, by pressing a PTT button, and one